

3.1: Setting Up Wireless Access Points

We will consider two scenarios for configuring an Access Point. The first is where you just have a plain-Jane Access Point. The other is where the Access Point has a wireless broadband router with either cable or DSL or dial-up modem built in.

Connecting Two PCs Using An Access point

To connect two PCs wirelessly using a simple Access Point will need you to connect the Access Point to one of the system directly where you have the Internet connection coming in. This PC should have a Network Interface Card (NIC). The other machine should have wireless PCI adapter. An RJ45 cable is provided with some of the available Access Points.

Follow the steps as below to get an Access Point up and running:

1. Switch off the PC and connect the RJ45 cable to the Network Interface Card of the PC.
2. Connect the other side to the LAN port of the Access Point.
3. Power up the Access Point and make sure the LED indicates that everything is normal, as mentioned in the manual.
4. Now power up the PC and get the LAN on the same IP range as the Access Point is. The default IP address of the Access Point will be mentioned in the quick setup guide on the CD. A typical IP is 192.168.1.1 and a the corresponding subnet mask would be 255.255.255.0. If this is the IP of the Access Point, then give the LAN an IP something like 192.168.1.2, up to 254.
5. Once the TCP/IP settings are configured, it is time to ping the Access Point to check whether everything is working properly.
6. To ping, click Start > Run, and in the dialog box, type in "ping <IP address of Access Point>"